Dietary Guidelines

Foods to be included	Foods to be avoided
Rice flakes, puffed rice, well-cooked cereals, Cooked pulses, dairy products like milk, cream, boiled eggs, steamed fish, Well cooked vegetables Desserts such as custard	Raw vegetables, raw unripe fruits, Beverages - strong tea, coffee, cola, processed foods- pickles, spices, pastries, sweets, all fried foods, Spices -Pepper, chillies

1.3.2 Diarrhoea

Diarrhoea is often a symptom of a systemic disease caused by viral and bacterial organisms. It is defined as frequent passage of loose, watery stools which may contain blood or mucous.

Causes of Diarrhoea

Diarrhoea results from changes in the mucosa of the small and large intestines. Diarrhoea may be due to many causes. The more common causes are:

- **Viral Infection :** e.g. 'intestinal' flu, a common term for infection of the bowels by the influenza virus and rota virus.
- **Bacterial Infection :** 50 percent of the cases are due to bacterial infections of the gut. Bacteria produce toxin in the gut e.g. Vibrio cholerae, Shigella.
- **Food poisoning :** Poor food hygiene and improperly handled food as a result of food being prepared with unwashed hands, food exposed to flies or cockroaches, or left at room temperature for a long time.

Symptoms of Diarrhoea

Diarrhoea means passing loose or watery stools several times a day. It is usually a symptom of an inflamed intestine or bowels. The inflammation results in food hurrying through the bowels. This leaves too little time for water to be absorbed from the bowel contents back into the body. Diarrhoea can be uncomfortable especially when accompanied by abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting or fever. Diarrhoea can lead to dehydration.

Principles of Diet

A high calorie, high protein, moderate fat, low fibre, high fluid and low residue diet is recommended. Initially liquid diet followed by soft bland diet.

Dietary Management

After recovery the following diet is given.

Energy: Energy intake is increased by 10-20% due to increase in BMR.

Carbohydrate: Carbohydrate intake is increased. to meet the increased energy requirement,

Protein: The protein requirement is increased.

Fats: Only moderate amount of fat should be given.

Minerals: The requirement of calcium and iron is increased during diarrhoea.

Vitamins: Sufficient amount of fat soluble vitamin A is required.

Dietary fibre: Low fibre diets in recommended in diarrhoea in order to avoid stress in GI tract. Foods rich in fibre have high residue, so it should be avoided. It is recommended to give low residue food.

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